Market Scan

Connected machines · SDV · AI · data · digital twins

Edition 006
Week of 26–30 Oct 2026
Cubic³ Business Development · Confidential

Signal of the week

Toyota commits all 50 global nameplates to SDV platform by 2030

Toyota told European investors that all roughly 50 global nameplates will run its SDV platform by 2030, with Woven by Toyota's Arene OS moving from the 2025 RAV4 to the 2026 Lexus ES.

Why it matters — Largest OEM commits its full line-up to a single vehicle OS within four years.

Sources: Mynavi (2026-10-21)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect-ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins	Regu-latory	Cyber-security	Quality	Telematics services
Automotive	4	1	1	1	0	1	1	1	0
Robotics / AV	1	1	4	0	0	2	0	0	1
Fleets	1	2	1	1	0	2	1	1	1
Energy	3	1	1	0	0	2	1	2	1
Agri / industrial	0	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	2

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6), by theme: none 1–2 3–5 6+

The read-across

Software-defined vehicles dominated the week across every domain, with quality and cybersecurity themes catching up with the architecture shift. Volkswagen's remote 80% charge cap on 73,000 EVs, Toyota's software-driven recall campaigns, and OTA fixes across Ram, Ford and Rivian show software defects now driving mainstream recall activity. ISO/SAE 21434 entering revision resets compliance roadmaps industry-wide.

Waymo entered Madrid and Pony.ai with NVIDIA moved into Astana, whilst GM narrowed its autonomy scope to L3 highway driving. Toyota committed all 50 nameplates to a single vehicle OS by 2030. NTT wrapped Komatsu's Saudi Arabian fleet in a compliant IoT solution, and E.ON and BMW opened Germany's first commercial V2G tariff on the iX3.

75
candidates screened

15
items featured

7
deals logged

Automotive OEMs

Cybersecurity | Regulatory | SDV

ISO formally decides to revise ISO/SAE 21434 after systematic review closes

ISO closed the systematic review of ISO/SAE 21434:2021 on 2 October 2026 and decided to revise the standard, with a second edition expected to take three or more years.

So what — Baseline automotive cybersecurity standard enters formal revision, resetting compliance roadmaps.

Articlesedge, 2026-10-25

Quality | SDV

Toyota's six biggest 2026 US recalls hit 1.7 million vehicles, half software-caused

An NHTSA analysis published on 22 October 2026 found Toyota's six largest 2026 US recalls cover nearly 1.7 million vehicles, with three caused by software defects.

So what — Software now drives half of Toyota's largest recall campaigns, reshaping warranty economics.

Autoblog, 2026-10-22 · NHTSA, 2026-10-13

SDV | AI

Xpeng offers to license full SDV stack to other automakers on VW template

Xpeng has formally offered to licence its SDV software stack, including centralised architecture and AI-driven ADAS, to other automakers, citing its Volkswagen partnership as the commercial template. The arrangement gives Xpeng recurring revenue outside EU tariff reach.

So what — Chinese vehicle OS enters the market as a licensable platform for Western OEMs.

Automotive World, 2026-10-16

Robotics and autonomous vehicles

AI | Regulatory

Waymo wins Spanish DGT authorisation to launch Madrid robotaxi service in 2027

Waymo confirmed on 20 October 2026 that it will launch fully autonomous ride-hailing in the Madrid region in 2027, its first Spanish deployment, after the DGT issued authorisation FVA-03/2026 covering 16 SAE Level 4 Jaguar I-PACE vehicles.

So what — First Level 4 robotaxi authorisation in Spain extends Waymo's European footprint.

The Olive Press, 2026-10-22

AI | Regulatory | Connectivity

inDrive, Pony.ai and NVIDIA sign MOU to pilot Gen-7 L4 robotaxis in Astana

inDrive signed a memorandum of understanding with Pony.ai and NVIDIA on 23 October 2026 to pilot Level 4 autonomous ride-hailing in Astana, Kazakhstan, deploying Pony.ai's Gen-7 robotaxis on NVIDIA's Hyperion platform, with testing targeted for H1 2027 under a government sandbox agreement.

So what — Named-account robotaxi expansion opens Central Asia on an NVIDIA reference stack.

Business Wire, 2026-10-23

SDV | AI

Rivian opens invite-only Autonomy Early Access with December hands-off, eyes-off delivery

Rivian launched an invite-only Autonomy Early Access Programme on 20 October 2026, targeting December delivery of its hands-off, eyes-off Point-to-Point feature to Autonomy+ subscribers on Gen 2 R1 and R2 vehicles in California and Florida.

So what — Second US OEM after Tesla opens a consumer eyes-off ADS programme on highways.

Self Drive News, 2026-10-20

Fleets

AI | Regulatory

GM exits robotaxi, pivots autonomy to L3 highway in Cadillac Escalade IQ by 2028

GM's Q3 2026 shareholder letter, published 20 October 2026, describes autonomy as a highway technology targeting eyes-off Level 3 driving in the Cadillac Escalade IQ from 2028, with no reference to a robotaxi business and a call for state laws recognising ADS as the driver when engaged.

So what — Named account retreats from robotaxi, narrowing US L4 competition and lobbying ADS legal status.

General Motors investor relations, 2026-10-20

Telematics services | Connectivity | Data mgmt

Coastr and Volteras partner to offer OEM telematics across 31 brands to leasing fleets

Coastr announced a partnership with Volteras on 26 October 2026 to provide rental and leasing firms with OEM-integrated telematics spanning 31 vehicle brands through a single platform, covering tracking, mileage, fault codes and servicing data without aftermarket hardware.

So what — Named-account leasing segment moves to embedded OEM data in place of hardware telematics.

Business Motoring, 2026-10-26

Cybersecurity | Connectivity | Regulatory

AUTOCRYPT details nationwide C-ITS security across 5,000 km at ITS World Congress

At ITS World Congress 2026 in Gangneung on 19–23 October, AUTOCRYPT highlighted C-ITS security deployments across 10 South Korean sites spanning over 5,000 km, and presented on privacy-preserving V2X tolling, secure vehicle-infrastructure data exchange and global cyber regulations.

So what — V2X cybersecurity moves from pilots to national-scale infrastructure deployment in South Korea.

PR Newswire, 2026-10-26

Energy

Quality · SDV · Regulatory · Cybersecurity

Volkswagen recalls 73,000 EVs worldwide and caps charging at 80% by OTA

Volkswagen expanded a US ID.4 recall to 72,668 ID.3, ID.4, ID.7, ID.Buzz and Cupra Born EVs globally after SK Battery America cells from 2022–2025 were found to risk thermal propagation above 80% charge.

So what — First mass remote charge limit imposed as a safety recall under R156-style OTA rules.

Electrek, 2026-10-21 · Electrek, 2026-10-20

Regulatory · Connectivity · Telematics services · SDV

E.ON and BMW launch Germany's first commercial V2G tariff on iX3

E.ON and BMW launched Germany's first regulator-approved commercial vehicle-to-grid product, paying BMW iX3 50 xDrive owners a connection bonus plus roughly €0.40 per kWh discharged, with charge and discharge cycles managed automatically by joint BMW–E.ON algorithms.

So what — Sets a European template for grid-interactive EV tariffs tied to OEM telematics.

Versinetic, 2026-10-07

SDV · AI · Quality

GM unveils fourth-generation EV platform with LMR cells and centralised compute

At GM Forward in New York on 21 October 2026, GM detailed a fourth-generation EV platform using lithium manganese-rich prismatic cells with roughly 33% more energy density than LFP, central compute delivering 40 times more processing power and 30% less wiring, with LMR production starting in Tennessee from 2028.

So what — Named account resets EV architecture around centralised compute and new cell chemistry.

GM Newsroom, 2026-10-21

Agri and industrial OEMs

Connectivity · Telematics services · Regulatory

NTT DOCOMO BUSINESS and stc Group launch compliant IoT for Komatsu in Saudi Arabia

NTT DOCOMO BUSINESS and Saudi Arabia's stc Group launched an IoT connectivity service for Komatsu's construction equipment fleet in the Kingdom to meet local telecoms regulations, supporting the Komtrax telematics platform and enabling wireless collection of operational data.

So what — Connectivity competitor NTT wraps a named account in a regulated-market IoT solution.

The Machine Maker, 2026-10-19

AI · Telematics services · Digital twins

Komatsu commissions its 1,000th autonomous ultra-class haul truck in Nevada

Komatsu, which first commercialised autonomous haulage in 2008, commissioned its 1,000th autonomous ultra-class truck at a Nevada gold mine in April 2026, marking a scaling inflection for Autonomous Haulage System deployments across global mining.

So what — Named account reaches 1,000-truck autonomous fleet, setting the benchmark for off-highway AHS.

The Manifest Archive, 2026-10-08

Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
E.ON	BMW	First commercial V2G tariff in Germany on iX3	Energy	Partner
Waymo	DGT (Spain)	FVA-03/2026 authorisation for 16 L4 robotaxis in Madrid	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Pony.ai	inDrive and NVIDIA	MOU for L4 robotaxi pilot in Astana H1 2027	Robotics / AV	Prospect
NTT DOCOMO BUSINESS	stc Group and Komatsu	Compliant IoT connectivity for Komatsu fleet in Saudi Arabia	Agri / industrial	Competitive
Xpeng	Volkswagen (template)	SDV stack licensing offer to third-party OEMs	Automotive	Competitive
Coastr	Volteras	OEM telematics access across 31 brands for leasing and rental	Fleets	Partner
Volvo Trucks	Waabi	Commercial driverless freight operations in Texas	Robotics / AV	Partner

Watch list

Samsara opens Germany office to enter European fleet telematics market. Named telematics competitor opens a European base against incumbent fleet telematics providers.

Simplex Wireless outlines SGP.32 eSIM retrofit path for EV chargers. Standardised eSIM swap for installed charger estates moves from specification to vendor playbook.

Method: news published 19–25 Oct 2026; 75 candidates screened across ~60 sources; items scored 0–10 on significance, novelty and relevance; threshold 6. Themes: SDV, connectivity, AI, data management, digital twins, regulatory framework, cybersecurity, quality and telematics services. Full source list in editions/ on GitHub.